**INSTRUCTIONAL AREA**
Product/Services Management

# HOSPITALITY SERVICES
# TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

## PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

## 21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

## PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function.
2. Explain the concept of product mix.
3. Explain the nature of product/service branding.
4. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.
5. Identify the company's brand promise.

**EVENT SITUATION**

You are to assume the roles of the brand manager and the guest experience coordinator for ECO RETREAT, an eco-friendly resort chain that focuses on sustainable tourism and immersive nature experiences. The resort has gained popularity over the past five years, particularly among environmentally conscious travelers seeking unique vacations. However, the CEO (judge) is concerned about the brand's positioning as more eco-resorts enter the market.

The CEO has tasked your team with developing a new suite of packages aimed at families and groups, promoting eco-friendly activities while ensuring an unforgettable experience. These packages should include accommodations in eco-friendly lodges, guided nature tours, and hands-on experiences like organic farming workshops or wildlife conservation activities.

In addition to package development, the CEO wants your recommendations on how to market these new offerings. Consider how to emphasize the sustainable aspects of the resort and its activities while also highlighting the unique experiences families can enjoy together. The CEO is particularly interested in strategies to engage potential guests through social media, partnerships with travel influencers, and community outreach programs.

You will present your ideas to the CEO (judge) in an engaging meeting setting, which includes visuals of the resort, examples of potential activities, and sample itineraries for the new packages. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by welcoming you and expressing excitement about your proposals. After you have presented your concepts and answered the CEO’s questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your innovative ideas.

Potential Judge's Questions:

1. What strategies did you consider to differentiate ECO RETREAT from other eco-resorts, especially as the market becomes more competitive?
2. What specific social media strategies do you envision implementing to engage families and groups, and how will you measure the success of these campaigns?

| Rate the participants' ability to: | | Novice | Developing | Proficient | Exemplary | Judged Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **PERFORMANCE INDICATORS** | | | | | | |
| 1. | Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 2. | Explain the concept of product mix. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 3. | Explain the nature of product/service branding. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 4. | Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 5. | Identify the company's brand promise. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| **SOLUTION** | | | | | | |
| 6. | **Unique**<br>Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 7. | **Practical**<br>Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 8. | **Effective**<br>Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| **CAREER COMPETENCIES** | | | | | | |
| 9. | **Critical Thinking**<br>Think critically to understand and solve problems. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 10. | **Communication**<br>Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 11. | **Decision Making**<br>Consider the impacts of decisions. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| **OVERALL IMPRESSION** | | | | | | |
| 12. | Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| | | | | | **TOTAL SCORE** | |